

English Vocabulary - English Vocabulary

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BOOK HIGHLIGHTS & LEARNING FEATURES

- ' Structured 14-Section Comprehensive Mastery Layout
- ' Visual Memory Cards, Mnemonics & Sound Associations
- ' Exam Trend Analysis, PYQ Notes & Shortcut Formulas
- ' High-Retention Active Recall & Common Mistake Alerts
- ' Quick Revision Summary & One-Page Exam Formula Sheet



By the end of this chapter, you will master:

- The precise definition, part of speech, and contextual usage of 40 high-frequency "F" words commonly tested in competitive exams (SSC CGL/CHSL, Banking PO/Clerk, UPSC, State PSC, and MBA entrance tests).
- Etymological roots, prefixes, and suffixes that govern vocabulary formation (e.g., fore-, fract-, fort-*).
- Synonyms and antonyms of these core words to expand your active vocabulary by over 200 lexical items.
- The subtle nuances between easily confused word pairs (e.g., fortuitous vs. fortunate, foreboding vs. forbidding*).
- Exam-specific strategies to solve sentence equivalence, cloze tests, and synonym-antonym questions with 100% accuracy.

Quick Overview & Chapter Roadmap

In competitive examinations, English vocabulary is not merely about rote memorization; it is about understanding semantic nuance and syntactic application. Words beginning with the letter "F" are statistically among the most highly tested across major government exams. These words frequently carry dual meanings, abstract applications, or historical roots that examiners love to exploit in trick questions.

Roadmap of the Chapter:

1. Morphology & Root Analysis: Understanding how Latin and Greek roots shape the words in our list.
2. The Master Lexicon Grid: A comprehensive lookup table featuring all 40 words with meanings, synonyms, and antonyms.
3. In-Depth Semantic Breakdown: Comprehensive profiles of each of the 40 words, including grammatical properties, history, and usage in classical/modern literature.
4. Worked Application and Practice: Exercises specifically tailored to match current exam patterns.
5. Mnemonic Vault: Psychological associations, phonetic links, and visual cues designed to prevent memory retention failure under exam stress.

Main Concepts & Root Analysis

To build an adaptable vocabulary, we must decode the building blocks of words. Many of the "F" words in this chapter are derived from classical roots:

Key Roots, Prefixes & Suffixes

Root/Prefix	Meaning	Etymological Origin	Exemplar Words from the Chapter
Fore-	Before, in front, beforehand	Old English	Foreboding, Foreclose, Foreordain, Foreshadow, Forestall
Fract- / Frag-	To break, shatter	Latin (frangere)	Fractious, Friction, Fraction
Fort-	Strength, courage, strong	Latin (fortis)	Fortitude, Forte, Fortress, Fortify
Fug-	To flee, run away	Latin (fugere)	Fugitive, Refuge, Subterfuge
For-	Away, off, completely	Old English	Forbear, Forswear, Forfeit, Forlorn

+P IMPORTANT POINT

+P IMPORTANT:

KEY NOTE

Recognizing prefixes like Fore- immediately indicates that the word deals with a future event or prior action. Conversely, the prefix For- often indicates negation, rejection, or abandonment. Identifying these prefixes helps in utilizing the elimination method during examinations when unfamiliar words appear.

Detailed Explanations & Theory

Here is the master lexicon of the 40 essential "F" words, complete with definitions, synonyms, antonyms, and illustrative context.

The Master Lexicon Grid

	Word	Part of Speech	Primary Meaning	Key Synonyms	Key Antonyms
1	Foil	Verb / Noun	Prevent from succeeding; frustrate; defeat	Baffle, thwart, circumvent	Assist, abet, facilitate
2	Folly	Noun	Lack of good sense; foolishness	Silliness, absurdity, insanity	Wisdom, prudence, sagacity
3	Foment	Verb	Instigate or stir up an undesirable course of action	Incite, provoke, agitate	Dampen, quell, calm, appease
4	Foolhardy	Adjective	Recklessly bold or rash	Audacious, temerarious, headlong	Cautious, prudent, circumspect
5	Foppish	Adjective	Concerned with clothes and appearance in an affected manner	Dandyish, dapper, coxcombical	Unaffected, dowdy, slovenly
6	Forage	Verb / Noun	Search widely for food or provisions	Scavenge, hunt, rummage	Starve, abstain, hoard
7	Foray	Noun / Verb	A sudden attack or incursion into enemy territory	Raid, inroad, depredation	Retreat, withdrawal, defense
8	Forbear	Verb	Politely or patiently refrain from doing something	Resist, abstain, eschew	Indulge, continue, yield
9	Forbidding	Adjective	Unfriendly, threatening, or grim in appearance	Hostile, menacing, sinister	Inviting, friendly, congenial
10	Foreboding	Noun / Adj.	A feeling that something bad will happen	Apprehension, premonition, augury	Providence, optimism, hope
11	Foreclose	Verb	Rule out or prevent; exclude; deprive of mortgage rights	Preclude, bar, debar	Allow, permit, facilitate

12	Foreordain	Verb	Appoint or decree beforehand	Predetermine, destine, preordain	Chance, accidental, improvise
13	Foreshadow	Verb	Be a warning or indication of a future event	Augur, presage, portend	Hindsight, review, retrospect
14	Forestall	Verb	Prevent or obstruct an anticipated event by taking advance action	Preempt, anticipate, intercept	Assist, encourage, expedite
15	Forfeit	Verb / Noun	Lose or be deprived of property/right as a penalty	Surrender, yield, relinquish	Reclaim, win, retain
16	Forge	Verb / Noun	Shape metal; create; counterfeit/ fabricate	Fashion, fabricate, falsify	Destroy, ruin, dismantle
17	Forlorn	Adjective	Pitifully sad and abandoned or lonely	Desolate, wretched, miserable	Cheerful, happy, hopeful
18	Formidable	Adjective	Inspiring fear or respect through size, power, or intensity	Daunting, intimidating, colossal	Comforting, easy, insignificant
19	Formulaic	Adjective	Produced according to a formula; conventional; unoriginal	Hackneyed, cliché, stock	Original, creative, novel
20	Forswear	Verb	Agree to give up or do without; renounce	Repudiate, abjure, recant	Accept, claim, embrace
21	Forte	Noun	A thing at which someone excels; their strong point	Strength, specialty, talent	Weakness, foible, inadequacy
22	Forthright	Adjective	Outspoken, straightforward, and honest	Candid, frank, blunt	Deceitful, devious, evasive
23	Fortitude	Noun	Courage in pain or adversity	Bravery, resilience, mettle	Cowardice, weakness, timidity
24	Fortuitous	Adjective	Happening by accident or chance rather than design	Accidental, lucky, serendipitous	Intentional, planned, deliberate
25	Foster	Verb	Encourage or promote the development of; nurture	Cultivate, cherish, support	Discourage, neglect, stifle
26	Founder	Verb / Noun	(Of a ship) sink; fail utterly or collapse	Submerge, capsize, miscarry	Succeed, float, flourish
27	Fracas	Noun	A noisy disturbance or quarrel; brawl	Melee, affray, skirmish	Peace, agreement, harmony

28	Fractious	Adjective	Irritable and quarrelsome; difficult to control	Unruly, peevish, petulant	Affable, obedient, docile
29	Franchise	Noun / Verb	An authorization or privilege; right to vote	Suffrage, charter, permit	Slavery, disenfranchisement
30	Frantic	Adjective	Wild or distraught with fear, anxiety, or other emotion	Frenzied, hysterical, hectic	Calm, peaceful, serene
31	Fraternize	Verb	Associate or form a friendship with someone (often forbidden)	Hobnob, consort, socialize	Shun, avoid, estrange
32	Fraudulent	Adjective	Obtained, done by, or involving deception; dishonest	Deceitful, duplicitous, sham	Honest, genuine, authentic
33	Fraught	Adjective	Filled with or likely to result in something undesirable	Teeming, loaded, anxious	Empty, calm, devoid
34	Fray	Noun / Verb	A noisy fight; unravel or wear out	Conflict, battle; tatter, chafe	Peace, harmony; mend, sew
35	Frenetic	Adjective	Fast and energetic in a wild, uncontrolled way	Frantic, chaotic, hyperactive	Calm, leisurely, placid
36	Friction	Noun	Surface resistance; conflict or clash	Rubbing; discord, dissension	Agreement, harmony, lubrication
37	Frivolous	Adjective	Not having any serious purpose or value	Silly, trivial, superficial	Serious, important, profound
38	Frowzy	Adjective	Scruffy and neglected in appearance; musty	Slovenly, untidy, fusty	Neat, clean, spruce
39	Frugal	Adjective	Sparing or economical with regard to money or food	Thrifty, parsimonious, sparing	Extravagant, wasteful, prodigal
40	Fugitive	Noun / Adj.	A person fleeing from arrest/danger; fleeting	Runaway, deserter; transient	Enduring, permanent, native

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In-Depth Semantic Breakdown & Contextual Nuance

Foil (Verb / Noun)

- Contextual Nuance: As a verb, it means to defeat a person's efforts or plans. As a noun, it can refer to a person or thing that contrasts with and so enhances the qualities of another (e.g., "A straight man acts as a foil* to the comic lead").
- Example Sentence: The security system was sophisticated enough to foil the bank robbers' carefully planned heist.*

Folly (Noun)

- Contextual Nuance: Refers to foolishness or a foolish act. In architecture, a "folly" is a costly, ornamental building with no practical purpose, built on an estate.
- Example Sentence: It is sheer folly to believe that you can pass the civil services examination without studying the daily newspapers.*

Foment (Verb)

- Contextual Nuance: Frequently tested in the context of political rebellions or social unrest. It should not be confused with ferment* (which refers to biological/chemical breakdown or general excitement).
- Example Sentence: The rebel leaders attempted to foment discord among the border tribes to weaken the central government's authority.*

Foolhardy (Adjective)

- Contextual Nuance: Unlike "brave" or "courageous," foolhardy* always carries a highly negative connotation of stupidity mixed with boldness.
- Example Sentence: Attempting to climb Mount Everest in a raging blizzard without oxygen is foolhardy, not heroic.*

Foppish (Adjective)

- Contextual Nuance: Derived from the noun "fop" (a man concerned with his clothes and appearance in an affected way). It implies a vain, shallow interest in superficial elegance.
- Example Sentence: His foppish manners and extravagant attire made him the object of ridicule among the rugged villagers.*

Forage (Verb / Noun)

- Contextual Nuance: Originally used to describe search parties (soldiers) seeking food for horses or livestock. Now used broadly for any desperate search for food or materials.
- Example Sentence: During the harsh winter months, wild animals are forced to forage in urban areas for survival.*

Foray (Noun / Verb)

- Contextual Nuance: A quick, sudden offensive incursion. It can also be used metaphorically for a brief excursion into a new field of activity (e.g., "The novelist's foray* into screenwriting").
- Example Sentence: The military platoon made a midnight foray into the enemy's ammunition depot.*

Forbear (Verb)

- Contextual Nuance: To refrain from. Do not confuse with the noun Forebear, which means an ancestor or forefather.
- Example Sentence: Despite being insulted publicly, the diplomat managed to forbear from making an angry retort.*

Forbidding (Adjective)

- Contextual Nuance: Threatening, hostile, or dauntingly difficult.
- Example Sentence: The forbidden forest presented a forbidding barrier of thorny bushes and dark, tangled vines.*

Foreboding (Noun / Adjective)

- Contextual Nuance: An intuitive feeling of coming evil or misfortune. It differs from apprehension* because it usually implies a specific, darker prophetic sense.
- Example Sentence: As the dark clouds gathered overhead, a deep sense of foreboding settled over the coastal town.*

Foreclose (Verb)

- Contextual Nuance: In law, to deprive of the right to redeem a mortgage. Idiomatically, it means to shut out, exclude, or prevent any further discussion on an issue.
- Example Sentence: The sudden rejection of the proposal foreclosed any possibility of an amicable settlement.*

Foreordain (Verb)

- Contextual Nuance: Heavily connected with the theological concept of predestination.

- Example Sentence: Some cultures believe that our marriages are foreordained in heaven before we are born.*

Foreshadow (Verb)

- Contextual Nuance: A literary device. Unlike foretell*, it does not state a future event explicitly, but hints at it subtly through symbols or minor occurrences.
- Example Sentence: The eerie silence of the birds in the opening scene foreshadows the natural disaster that strikes later.*

Forestall (Verb)

- Contextual Nuance: Action taken beforehand to make an anticipated event impossible or ineffective.
- Example Sentence: The central bank raised interest rates to forestall the rising threat of runaway inflation.*

Forfeit (Verb / Noun)

- Contextual Nuance: Giving up a right or possession because of a breach of contract, a crime, or a neglect of duty.
- Example Sentence: If you fail to show up for the match, you will forfeit your chance to play in the finals.*

Forge (Verb / Noun)

- Contextual Nuance: To forge has positive meanings (to build up a relationship or alliance: "to forge* a path") and highly negative meanings (to copy or falsify documents/currency).
- Example Sentence: The two nations managed to forge a strong strategic alliance despite their historical differences.*

Forlorn (Adjective)

- Contextual Nuance: Abandoned, hopeless, or highly unlikely to succeed (e.g., "a forlorn* hope").
- Example Sentence: The lost child sat on the bench with a forlorn expression, crying out for his mother.*

Formidable (Adjective)

- Contextual Nuance: Inspiring awe, reverence, or fear because of impressive power, skill, or size. It can refer to an opponent, a task, or an obstacle.
- Example Sentence: The champion boxer was a formidable opponent who had never been defeated in his career.*

Formulaic (Adjective)

- Contextual Nuance: Derogatory term for works of art, writing, or policies that are predictable and unoriginal.
- Example Sentence: Critics dismissed the new summer blockbuster as a formulaic action movie devoid of any emotional depth.*

Forswear (Verb)

- Contextual Nuance: To swear falsely (perjure oneself) or to solemnly renounce or give up.
- Example Sentence: As a condition of the peace treaty, the warlord had to forswear any future use of violence.*

Forte (Noun)

- Contextual Nuance: Pronounced /fɔːrteɪn/ "fort-ay". It represents a person's strongest talent. Derived from the French word for "strong."
- Example Sentence: Public speaking was never her forte; she preferred expressing her ideas through writing.*

Forthright (Adjective)

- Contextual Nuance: Direct and outspoken without any hesitation or attempt to hide one's true feelings.
- Example Sentence: The manager appreciated her forthright feedback, even though it was highly critical of his style.*

Fortitude (Noun)

- Contextual Nuance: Mental and emotional strength in facing difficulty, adversity, danger, or temptation courageously.
- Example Sentence: The refugees showed immense fortitude in rebuilding their lives from scratch in a foreign land.*

Fortuitous (Adjective)

- Contextual Nuance: Often confused with fortunate. While fortunate means lucky, fortuitous* strictly means happening by chance (which may or may not have a lucky outcome), though modern usage has conflated the two.
- Example Sentence: Their meeting at the airport was fortuitous, as neither of them knew the other was traveling.*

Foster (Verb)

- Contextual Nuance: To promote growth or to raise a child who is not one's own by birth.
- Example Sentence: The mentor tried to foster a spirit of collaborative innovation among the young interns.*

Founder (Verb / Noun)

- Contextual Nuance: As a noun, the creator. As a verb, it means to sink (of a ship) or to fail completely due to a specific obstacle.
- Example Sentence: The peace talks foundered on the controversial issue of territorial borders.*

Fracas (Noun)

- Contextual Nuance: Pronounced /fræk% ð/. A noisy, disorderly fight, brawl, or disturbance.
- Example Sentence: A minor argument over a parking space quickly escalated into a full-blown fracas involving dozens of neighbors.*

Fractious (Adjective)

- Contextual Nuance: Quarrelsome, irritable, or refractory. It is often used to describe children, crowds, or political factions.
- Example Sentence: The fractious crowd began throwing stones at the police officers stationed near the stadium.*

Franchise (Noun / Verb)

- Contextual Nuance: The constitutional right to vote (often called "the franchise" or "elective franchise") or a commercial license to market a company's goods.
- Example Sentence: The historical struggle for the franchise culminated in the universal suffrage movement.*

Frantic (Adjective)

- Contextual Nuance: Overwhelmed with urgency, fear, panic, or excitement.
- Example Sentence: The parents made frantic efforts to contact the rescue team when their child went missing in the woods.*

Fraternize (Verb)

- Contextual Nuance: Often carries a negative or forbidden military connotation, such as associating with the enemy or with soldiers of lower ranks in a way that breaches discipline.
- Example Sentence: Soldiers were strictly forbidden to fraternize with the citizens of the occupied territory.*

Fraudulent (Adjective)

- Contextual Nuance: Characterized by, based on, or obtained by fraud; duplicitous.
- Example Sentence: The businessman was arrested for securing a multimillion-dollar bank loan through fraudulent documents.*

Fraught (Adjective)

- Contextual Nuance: Usually followed by the preposition "with" (e.g., "fraught with danger" or "fraught with* difficulties"). It can also stand alone to describe a situation filled with high tension.
- Example Sentence: The journey through the dense, swampy jungle was fraught with the danger of predator attacks.*

Fray (Noun / Verb)

- Contextual Nuance: As a noun, a noisy fight or contest. As a verb, to unweave, wear thin, or strain (e.g., "nerves frayed* by noise").
 - Example Sentence: The eager politician was ready to enter the electoral fray and debate his opponents.*
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Frenetic (Adjective)

- Contextual Nuance: Lacking calm, order, or quiet; highly frenzied.
- Example Sentence: The trading floor of the stock exchange was filled with frenetic activity during the final hour.*

Friction (Noun)

- Contextual Nuance: Physical resistance of movement, or interpersonal conflict and clash of temperaments.
- Example Sentence: There was constant friction between the creative director and the conservative financial manager.*

Frivolous (Adjective)

- Contextual Nuance: Lacking intellectual substance, gravity, or importance. In law, a "frivolous lawsuit" is one with no legal merit.
- Example Sentence: Do not waste your hard-earned money on frivolous purchases like designer shoes and luxury watches.*

Frowzy (Adjective)

- Contextual Nuance: Dirty, untidy, slovenly, or having an unpleasant smell from confinement or neglect.
- Example Sentence: The old bachelor lived in a frowzy apartment cluttered with dusty books and unwashed dishes.*

Frugal (Adjective)

- Contextual Nuance: Economical, saving, or sparing. Unlike "miserly" or "parsimonious," frugal* has a positive connotation of wise money management.
- Example Sentence: By maintaining a frugal lifestyle, the young couple saved enough money to buy their own house.*

Fugitive (Noun / Adjective)

- Contextual Nuance: A runaway fleeing justice, or something extremely short-lived, fleeting, or transient (e.g., "a fugitive* thought").
- Example Sentence: The escaped prisoner lived as a fugitive in the remote mountain cabins for over three years.*

PYQ Discussion & Exam Trends

Competitive exams frequently target these words because they are prone to contextual confusion or have tricky synonyms.

Analysis of Exam Trends:

1. Sentence Equivalence / Double Fillers: Words like Fortuitous and Fractious are examiners' favorites. In double-filler questions, fortuitous is often paired with a positive word, testing whether the student knows it means "by chance" rather than "lucky."
2. Confusing Homophones and Close Words:
 - Forbear (to refrain/abstain) vs. Forebear (ancestor).
 - Foment (to instigate/provoke) vs. Ferment (excite/biologically break down).
 - Forestall (to preempt/prevent) vs. Foretell (to predict).
3. Tone Identification: Knowing if a word is positive, negative, or neutral is vital. For example, Foolhardy has a highly negative charge, while Bravery is positive. Frugal is positive, whereas Parsimonious is negative.

Shortcuts & Exam Tricks

When facing a tough vocabulary question in an exam, use these fast-acting techniques:

&j EXAM SHORTCUT

&j SHORTCUT: The Charge/Tone Technique

KEY NOTE

Assign a positive (+) or negative (-) charge to the word.

KEY NOTE

Foolhardy* -> Bold, but stupid (-)

KEY NOTE

Fortitude* -> Courage under pain (+)

KEY NOTE

Fractious* -> Irritable (-)

KEY NOTE

Frugal* -> Saving money (+)

KEY NOTE

If the sentence context is negative, eliminate all positive option choices immediately.

Ø=Ü; SMART TRICK

Ø=Ü; SMART TRICK: The Root-Splicing Method

KEY NOTE

Break down compound words or words with clear prefixes.

KEY NOTE

Forestall: "Fore" (before) + "stall" (to stop/prevent). Thus, forestall means to stop something before* it happens.

KEY NOTE

Foreboding: "Fore" (before) + "boding" (feeling/shaping). Thus, foreboding means a bad feeling before* an event.

Memory Tricks & Mnemonics

To ensure lifelong retention, use these custom phonetic and associative mnemonics:

- Foment: Foment* sounds like Foam on the Fire. If you throw foam or chemicals on a fire, you stir it up and incite a reaction.
- Fractious: Think of Frustrated Factions. When a political party splits into small factions, they become irritable and argumentative (fractious*).
- Fortitude: Think of a Fortress. A fortress stands strong against any attack. Having fortitude* means your mind is as strong as a fortress in times of pain.
- Frail / Fray: Fray sounds like fray-ed wires. When wires are frayed, they unravel and cause a short-circuit, leading to a fight/clash (fray*).
- Frugal: Think of Fruit-girl. A girl who eats only cheap, seasonal fruits to save money is being frugal*.
- Frowzy: Sounds like Drowsy and Dirty. A frowzy person is messy, untidy, and neglected, looking as if they just woke up drowsy.

Common Mistakes to Avoid

Ø=P" COMMON MISTAKE ALERT

Ø=P" COMMON MISTAKE: Fortuitous vs. Fortunate

KEY NOTE

Fortuitous means happening purely by accident or chance (e.g., a fortuitous meeting*). It does not guarantee a positive outcome.

KEY NOTE

Fortunate means having good fortune or being lucky (e.g., he was fortunate to win the lottery*).

KEY NOTE

Do not use fortuitous to mean fortunate in exams!*

Ø=P" COMMON MISTAKE ALERT

Ø=P" COMMON MISTAKE: Foment vs. Ferment

KEY NOTE

Foment is active instigation (e.g., to foment a rebellion*).

KEY NOTE

Ferment is a state of excitement or chemical breakdown (e.g., the political scene was in a ferment*).

Summary & Key Takeaways

- Action Verbs: Foil, Foment, Forage, Forbear, Foreclose, Foreordain, Foreshadow, Forestall, Forfeit, Forge, Forswear, Foster, Founder, Fraternize.*
- Adjectives of Temperament: Foolhardy (negative rashness), Forthright (honest bluntness), Fractious (quarrelsome irritability), Frantic/Frenetic (wild excitement).*
- Nouns of Conflict: Fracas (noisy brawl), Fray (intense fight/battle), Friction (interpersonal discord).*
- Roots are Key: Always isolate Fore- (before) and Fort-* (strong) to decode unfamiliar options.

Practice Questions with Solutions

Questions 1–5: Synonym Identification

Directions: Choose the word which is most nearly the SAME in meaning to the given word.

FOMENT

- (a) Appease
- (b) Incite
- (c) Dampen
- (d) Cultivate

FOOLHARDY

- (a) Sagacious
- (b) Timid
- (c) Reckless

(d) Astute

FRACTIOUS

- (a) Amiable
- (b) Petulant
- (c) Obedient
- (d) Cohesive

FORSWEAR

- (a) Adopt
- (b) Abjure
- (c) Embrace
- (d) Claim

FORTUITOUS

- (a) Planned
- (b) Deliberate
- (c) Accidental
- (d) Designed

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Questions 6–10: Antonym Identification

Directions: Choose the word which is most nearly the OPPOSITE in meaning to the given word.

FORBIDDING

- (a) Menacing
- (b) Inviting
- (c) Hostile
- (d) Sinister

FRUGAL

- (a) Thrifty
- (b) Parsimonious
- (c) Sparing
- (d) Prodigal

FORTITUDE

- (a) Bravery
- (b) Timidity
- (c) Mettle
- (d) Resilience

FORLORN

- (a) Cheerful
 - (b) Desolate
 - (c) Wretched
 - (d) Lonely
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FOIL

- (a) Thwarten
- (b) Baffle
- (c) Facilitate
- (d) Circumvent

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Questions 11–15: Contextual Fillers

Directions: Fill in the blank with the most appropriate word from the options.

The peace negotiator made every effort to _____ the outbreak of hostilities between the two warring clans.

- (a) foment
- (b) forestall
- (c) foster
- (d) founder

His _____ style of communication, though appreciated by some for its honesty, often offended sensitive colleagues.

- (a) foppish
- (b) formulaic
- (c) forthright
- (d) frowzy

The ship _____ in the violent storm off the Cape of Good Hope, tragically losing all its cargo.

- (a) forged
- (b) foundered
- (c) foraged
- (d) forayed

The room was so _____ with unwashed laundry and stale food that the landlord refused to enter.

- (a) frowzy
- (b) foppish
- (c) frugal
- (d) fortuitous

The diplomatic mission was _____ with peril from the very beginning, owing to regional instability.

- (a) forlorn
- (b) formidable
- (c) fraught
- (d) frivolous

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Solutions with Detailed Explanations

1. Correct Answer: (b)

Explanation: Foment means to instigate or stir up (an undesirable course of action). Therefore, incite is its closest synonym. Appease (to calm) and Dampen are antonyms.

2. Correct Answer: (c)

Explanation: Foolhardy means recklessly bold or rash. Reckless is the correct synonym. Sagacious (wise), Timid (fearful), and Astute (shrewd) are incorrect.

3. Correct Answer: (b)

Explanation: Fractious means irritable and quarrelsome. Petulant (peevish/irritable) is the closest synonym. Amiable (friendly) and Obedient are antonyms.

4. Correct Answer: (b)

Explanation: Forswear means to formally reject, give up, or renounce. Abjure is a direct synonym meaning to solemnly renounce. Adopt, Embrace, and Claim are antonyms.

5. Correct Answer: (c)

Explanation: Fortuitous means happening by accident or chance. Thus, accidental is the correct synonym. Planned, Deliberate, and Designed are direct antonyms.

6. Correct Answer: (b)

Explanation: Forbidding means unfriendly or threatening. Its opposite is inviting. The other options (menacing, hostile, sinister) are synonyms.

7. Correct Answer: (d)

Explanation: Frugal means economical or thrifty. Its antonym is prodigal (wasteful/extravagant). Thrifty, parsimonious, and sparing are synonyms.

8. Correct Answer: (b)

Explanation: Fortitude means courage in pain or adversity. Its antonym is timidity (cowardice/fearfulness).

9. Correct Answer: (a)

Explanation: Forlorn means pitifully sad, lonely, and abandoned. Its antonym is cheerful.

10. Correct Answer: (c)

Explanation: To foil means to thwart or prevent. Its antonym is facilitate (to make easy/help).

11. Correct Answer: (b)

Explanation: The sentence requires a word meaning to prevent or head off. Forestall fits perfectly. Foment (incite) would worsen the hostilities.

12. Correct Answer: (c)

Explanation: The context refers to honesty and directness. Forthright (honest/straightforward) is the correct choice.

13. Correct Answer: (b)

Explanation: For a ship sinking, the verb founder is used. Forged (falsified/shaped) and foraged (searched for food) make no sense here.

14. Correct Answer: (a)

Explanation: The clues "unwashed laundry" and "stale food" point to frowzy (messy, untidy, musty).

15. Correct Answer: (c)

Explanation: "Fraught with peril" is a standard idiomatic expression meaning filled with danger.

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Final One-Page Quick Revision Sheet

' QUICK REVISION

' FINAL REVISION: The 10-Second High-Impact Table

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Word	Quick Meaning	Quick Mnemonic / Hook
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Foil	Thwart / Prevent	Wrapping foil blocks heat
Folly	Foolishness	Fool-y / Foolish behavior
Foment	Incite / Provoke	Foam on a fire (stirs up)
Foppish	Dandyish / Affected	Fop / Vain about clothes
Forbear	Refrain / Abstain	Bear with it / Hold back
Foreboding	Bad Omen / Premonition	Before-boding (dark omen)
Forestall	Preempt / Prevent	Stall it before it happens
Forlorn	Pitifully Sad / Abandoned	For-lost / Abandoned
Fortitude	Courage under pain	Fortress (mental strength)
Fortuitous	By Chance / Accidental	Fortune by chance
Founder	Sink / Fail	Ship's floor hits bottom
Fracas	Brawl / Disruption	Fracture caused by brawl
Fractious	Irritable / Unruly	Fraction splits party up
Fraught	Filled / Charged (with)	Freight ship loaded/teeming
Frowzy	Untidy / Musty	Drowsy and dirty
Frugal	Economical / Thrifty	Fruit-girl (economical)
Fugitive	Runaway / Fleeting	Refug-ee / Running away

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Ø=P Funny Memory Mode (Visual & Phonetic Mnemonics)

Here are the vocabulary memory cards, optimized in pure English for ultimate memory retention:

Word Card 1: Foment

- Word: Foment (Verb)
- Meaning: To stir up public trouble, instigate rebellion, or provoke anger.
- Funny Trick: Imagine a chef trying to make a giant pudding, but he puts too much Foam in it (Foment*). The kitchen explodes into foam, and all the customers start a huge riot, throwing plates!
- Sound Association: Foam + In + It.
- Example Sentence: The foreign spy tried to foment a rebellion by spreading false rumors on social media.*

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Word Card 2: Fractious

- Word: Fractious (Adjective)
- Meaning: Irritable, grumpy, easily angered, and very hard to control.
- Funny Trick: Imagine trying to solve math Fractions (Fractious*) at 3:00 AM while you are extremely sleepy. You get so angry that you rip the book apart and throw your pencil at the wall.
- Sound Association: Fractions.

- Example Sentence: The fractious toddlers refused to take a nap and threw their toys across the room.*

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Word Card 3: Fortitude

- Word: Fortitude (Noun)
- Meaning: Great strength of mind and courage when facing pain, danger, or trouble.
- Funny Trick: Imagine you are standing inside a super-strong stone Fort (Fortitude*) during a massive storm of flying pies. Because you are inside the fort, you have the attitude to stay calm and brave.
- Sound Association: Fort + Attitude.
- Example Sentence: She faced her long illness with incredible fortitude, never losing her beautiful smile.*

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Word Card 4: Frugal

- Word: Frugal (Adjective)
- Meaning: Very careful and sparing with money, food, or resources.
- Funny Trick: Think of a girl who only eats free Fruits (Frugal*) that fall from trees because she doesn't want to spend even a single dollar on groceries!
- Sound Association: Fruit + Girl.
- Example Sentence: Despite his massive wealth, the billionaire was so frugal that he always clipped grocery coupons.*

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Word Card 5: Foppish

- Word: Foppish (Adjective)
- Meaning: Extremely vain, silly, and obsessed with clothes, perfumes, and mirrors.
- Funny Trick: Imagine a man who loves his hair so much that he sprays Pop-ish (Foppish*) colored hairspray all day and carries a pink mirror everywhere, even while crossing busy streets.
- Sound Association: Fop (Vain man) + Pop-ish.
- Example Sentence: He spent hours in front of the mirror, adjusting his foppish silk tie and spraying perfume.*

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Word Card 6: Founder

- Word: Founder (Verb)
- Meaning: (Of a ship) to fill with water and sink; (Of a plan) to fail completely.
- Funny Trick: Imagine the Founder of a brand-new boat company standing on his flagship boat during its maiden voyage, only to watch the boat get a tiny leak and sink straight to the ocean floor.
- Sound Association: Founder (Creator).
- Example Sentence: The tech startup foundered because the co-founders could never agree on their product design.*

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Word Card 7: Foreboding

- Word: Foreboding (Noun)
- Meaning: A very strong, creepy feeling that something terrible is about to happen.
- Funny Trick: Imagine you see Four Boards (Foreboding*) of wood arranged in the shape of a coffin outside your front door. It instantly gives you a creepy, bad feeling about the day.
- Sound Association: Four + Boards.
- Example Sentence: When the engine suddenly made a strange clicking sound, the pilot felt a cold chill of foreboding.*

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Word Card 8: Fracas

- Word: Fracas (Noun)
- Meaning: A noisy, chaotic, and messy physical fight, brawl, or argument in public.
- Funny Trick: Imagine a street fight where people are throwing Raw Clay (Fracas*) and flower pots at each other, causing a massive, noisy mess in the middle of the road.
- Sound Association: Raw-clay / Fra-cas.
- Example Sentence: The security guards quickly stepped in to stop the fracas that broke out near the bar.*

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Word Card 9: Frowzy

- Word: Frowzy (Adjective)
- Meaning: Extremely messy, untidy, smelly, and neglected in appearance.
- Funny Trick: Think of a person who is so lazy and Drowsy (Frowzy*) that they have not combed their hair, washed their face, or cleaned their bedroom for three weeks.
- Sound Association: Drowsy + Messy.
- Example Sentence: He opened the door looking frowzy, wearing wrinkled pajamas and mismatched socks.*

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Word Card 10: Forestall

- Word: Forestall (Verb)
 - Meaning: To stop or prevent something from happening by taking action early.
 - Funny Trick: Imagine you see a wild bull running towards your market stall. To save your shop, you run out into the Forest and build a wall in front of your Stall (Forestall*) to block the bull early.
 - Sound Association: Forest + Stall.
 - Example Sentence: By drinking plenty of water and sleeping early, you can forestall a nasty seasonal cold.*
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